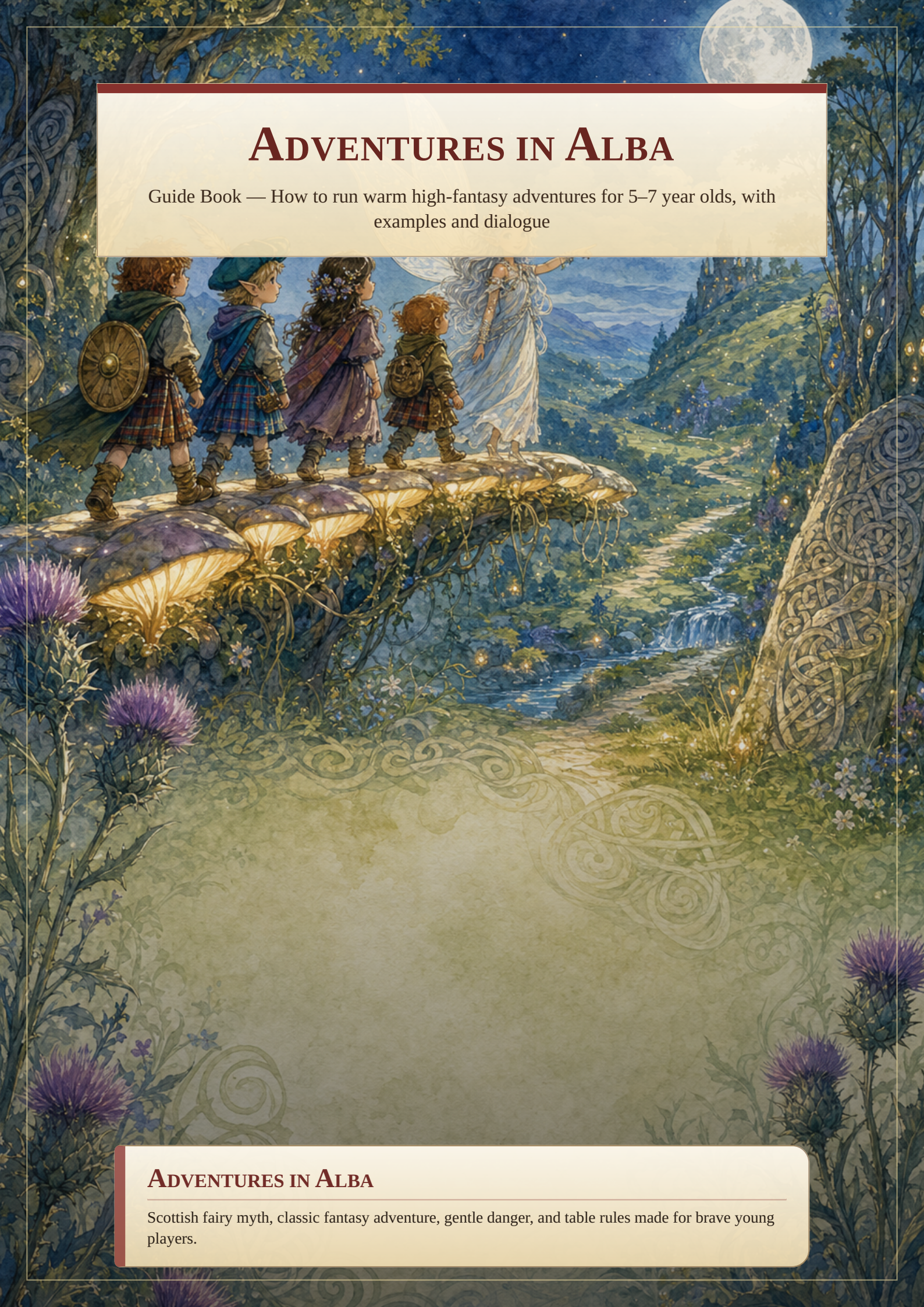


A whimsical illustration of four children and a fairy standing on a giant, glowing mushroom in a magical forest at night. The children are dressed in traditional Scottish kilts and a girl in a purple dress. The fairy has long, flowing white hair and wings. The forest is filled with large purple thistles, glowing mushrooms, and a large, ornate Celtic knot stone on the right. In the background, a castle sits on a hill under a full moon.

ADVENTURES IN ALBA

Guide Book — How to run warm high-fantasy adventures for 5–7 year olds, with examples and dialogue

ADVENTURES IN ALBA

Scottish fairy myth, classic fantasy adventure, gentle danger, and table rules made for brave young players.

YOUR JOB AS GUIDE

The Guide is not the boss of fun. You describe the world, listen to children, ask what they try, and help the dice turn ideas into surprises.

- Use short scenes: 5 to 12 minutes each.
- Give choices in twos or threes, not long menus.
- Name feelings before fights: scared, proud, sleepy, lonely, worried.
- Let adventurers succeed often. The fun is in how it happens.



Guide stance: make every scene readable from the art, then support the adventurer's idea.

Safety tone: no gore, no cruelty, no permanent harm. Trouble can be spooky, muddy, noisy, or puzzling.

Useful phrases

- “Yes, and what does that look like?”
- “Who are you helping?”
- “Which stat fits your idea?”
- “That is a wobble, so something funny changes.”

Guide rhythm

Picture → feeling → choice → roll only if exciting → warm change.

SCENE RECIPE

1. A picture

Start with something children can see: misty bridge, silver fox, giant teacup, glowing thistle.

2. A feeling

Pick one: worried, excited, lonely, sleepy, proud, grumpy, curious.

3. A choice

Offer two helpful directions: follow the bells or talk to the fox.

4. A roll

Only roll if the answer is exciting. Use Strength, Int, Agility, Wis, or Luck.

5. A change

After each scene, something should be different: a clue, friend, promise, opened path, or new question.

Read aloud: “The moon is caught in the loch like a silver coin. The kelpie foal stamps, worried and wet. What do you do?”



CREATURES ARE CHARACTERS

A creature should usually want something before it blocks something. Children can help, trick, soothe, race, sing, or befriend it.

RUNNING ROLLS AND WOBBLES

Choosing the stat

- Use **Strength** for lifting, climbing, holding, pushing, or protecting.
- Use **Int** for puzzles, plans, facts, reading runes, or clever tricks.
- Use **Agility** for speed, balance, dodging, sneaking, or catching.
- Use **Wis** for feelings, nature, animals, and noticing what matters.
- Use **Luck** for charms, surprises, fairy bargains, and last chances.

Good wobbles

- A hat blows away.
- The map gets wet.
- A bell rings and wakes someone.
- A helpful creature misunderstands.
- A path opens, but it is muddy.

Never make a wobble mean “you did nothing.”

Always move the story.

BUILDING ADVENTURES

Part	Question	Example
Hook	Who needs help?	A fairy cannot find the right door.
Path	Where must heroes go?	Across the heather bridge.
Friend	Who can help?	A shy fox with silver whiskers.
Puzzle	What needs a clever choice?	Three bells ring, but only one is kind.
Ending	How is the glen warmer now?	The lost moon-bell is returned.

Guide promise: prepare situations, not answers. If an adventurer invents a kind solution, let it matter.

TINY TABLES

What is strange here?

1	A thistle glows like a lantern.
2	Footprints turn into tiny flowers.
3	A crow speaks only in compliments.
4	The bridge asks for a joke.
5	A teacup storm rains indoors.
6	A sleeping troll snores bubbles.

What does the creature want?

1	A snack.
2	A song.
3	Someone to listen.
4	A lost button.
5	Help being brave.
6	A promise kept.

How can it enter a scene?

1	It blocks a path by accident.
2	It is crying quietly.
3	It has the clue but misunderstands it.
4	It challenges the heroes to a silly contest.
5	It asks for a promise.
6	It follows the heroes home.

SCENE DRESSING EXAMPLES

What to put in a scene

- **One clear picture:** a bridge with mossy faces, a teacup storm, a silver fox in heather.
- **One sound:** bell, splash, snore, giggle, creak, whisper.
- **One feeling:** lonely, proud, worried, sleepy, curious, embarrassed.
- **One useful object:** rope, button, lantern, map, boot, key, ribbon.
- **One choice:** talk first or look closer; cross now or find a safer path.

Example setup: “Rain taps the old bridge. A carved face blinks under moss. A red ribbon is tied around the middle stone.”

Dialogue starters

- Bridge: “I will not open for stomping feet. I open for polite ones.”
- Sprite: “I am not lost. I am doing royal path inspection.”
- Brownie: “Hold still! Those boots have clues on them!”
- Fox: “A clever adventurer would notice the quiet puddle, and you look very clever.”
- Owl: “Young acorn, I remember the path. I forgot the name of remembering.”

Ask the players: “What do you say back?” “Who helps?” “Which stat fits your idea?”

RUNNING DIALOGUE WITH YOUNG PLAYERS

Offer two tones

“Do you ask gently, make a joke, or stand tall?”
Children often answer faster when the choices are emotional.

Repeat their idea proudly

Adventurer: “I give it a biscuit.” Guide: “Excellent. You offer the dragon a biscuit like a peace treaty.”

Make NPCs want something

Every speaker wants a snack, a promise, a name remembered, a path cleaned, a song, or help being brave.

Let wobbles talk

On a wobble, the creature misunderstands: “You said boot? I thought you said flute!” Then the scene keeps moving.

Mini example: Guide: “The kelpie foal stamps, but its ears droop.” Player: “I talk quietly.” Guide: “That sounds like Wis. What do you say?” Player: “It is okay.” Guide: “Roll, and your friend may add +1 if they hum softly.”

USING HP, MP, AND ENEMY DR

Number	Guide meaning	Example
HP	How long a creature can stay in a tense scene.	A troll with high HP can keep holding a log bridge while heroes help.
MP	How much fairy weirdness it can use.	A sprite spends MP to grow thistles or vanish in petals.
Level	How experienced or important it is.	A level 1 hare is a messenger; a level 4 hare might guard a moon gate.
DR	Difficulty Rating: a quick “how big is this encounter?” number.	DR 1–2 easy, DR 3–4 fair, DR 5+ big scene or boss.

DR formula: $\text{round}((\text{HP} + \text{MP} + \text{Level} \times 3 + \text{positive stat bonuses} \times 2) \div 10)$. Use it to pace scenes, not to punish players.

Example: Bog-Boot Brownie has HP 8, MP 3, Level 2, positive stats total 5. $\text{DR} = \text{round}((8+3+6+10)/10) = 3$.

READY SCENE EXAMPLES

Scene: The Bootprint Road

Read aloud: “Golden bootprints glow in the mud. They walk in circles around a huge soggy boot. A muddy brownie waves a brush like a sword.”

- Ask: “Do you let it clean your boots, ask about the prints, or follow them?”
- Roll Wis to understand the brownie, Int to read the pattern, Agility to hop print to print.
- Wobble: the brownie cleans the map instead of the boots.

Scene: The Star Sheep

Read aloud: “A sheep made of cloud wool floats just above the hill. It bleats at a lonely star hiding behind a cloud.”

- Ask: “Do you sing, climb, shine a light, or ask what it lost?”
- Roll Luck for star magic, Wis for feelings, Strength to hold the kite-rope.
- Reward: the sheep makes a cloud bridge for one careful crossing.

SCENARIO FROM THE GUIDE SIDE: BELL-ROOT PATH

What the adventurers see

Read aloud: The path is moss-soft. Tiny bells hang from sleepy roots. A fox dreams beside a moon-rune door.

What is really happening?

- The bells are an alarm, but also a puzzle.
- The fox is guarding the door because it lost the key.
- The silver acorn key is under the quietest root.

Checks to offer

Idea	Stat	Result
Step around bells	Agility	Reach the door quietly.
Untie bells	Int	Learn which root hides the key.
Talk to fox	Wis	Fox admits it is worried.
Hold branch	Strength	Friend gets +1.
Lucky button	Luck	Find the quietest root.

Wobble: a bell rings, but it wakes the fox instead of starting a fight. Now dialogue begins.

SCENARIO FROM THE GUIDE SIDE: BRAMBLE COMBAT

Scene purpose

This is a combat scene that teaches danger without cruelty. The Bramble Sneak wants its shiny bell back and uses thorns to look bigger than it feels.

Creature plan

- Round 1: block the path and shout.
- Round 2: use Thorn Tangle if adventurers rush.
- At half HP: admit the bell is important.
- At 0 HP: tangled, tired, and ready to bargain.

Guide moves

Move	Use when	Safe result
Thorn Tangle	A hero runs straight in.	2 HP and stuck cloak.
Shiny Distraction	Someone shows treasure.	It pauses; next hero gets +1.
Cap Snag	On a wobble.	Its cap catches and reveals fear.

End warm: if adventurers return the bell, trade a button, or promise help, the Bramble Sneak becomes a grumpy shortcut guide.

MORE READY DIALOGUE

Gate with a voice

Read aloud: “The gate yawns. Password? it asks. Or snack-word. I accept both.” Use Int for clues, Luck for guessing, Wis for asking what it wants.

Proud tiny ruler

Sprite: “I decree that all heroes must admire my crown.” Good replies include compliments, jokes, drawing a flag, or asking if the sprite is lonely.

Helpful shopkeeper

Shopkeeper: “Copper buys rope, silver buys a kit, gold buys a favour, and mythral buys a legend. Spend kindly.”

Creature at 0 HP

Do not narrate harm. Say: “The creature is tired, muddy, and ready to listen.” Then offer help, promise, snack, or rest.

Scene loop example: picture → feeling → choice → roll → wobble or success → new clue. Keep naming the next useful thing children can touch, ask, follow, or comfort.

GUIDE DEPTH: BOSS SCENES AND SAFETY

Boss scene shape

- Show the scary picture safely: shadow, noise, weather, big feelings.
- Give the creature a want that can be discovered.
- Use HP to pace attention; use MP for special moves.
- At half HP, reveal the softer truth.
- At 0 HP, offer a bargain, apology, nap, or rescue.

Safety dials

If players are nervous	If players want more
Lower HP by 3.	Add a second objective.
Make special attacks cost +1 MP.	Let the creature change the map.
Have an NPC friend offer a hint.	Add a countdown: three bells before fog.

Rule: scary is allowed; hopeless is not. Always leave a visible kind choice.